

MIVA MERCHANT TEMPLATE AUDIT · JUNE 17, 2026

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Code Audit Report

Templates reviewed: SFNT · CTGY · CTGY_BRANDS · BSKE · EMAIL_ABANDONED_BASKET

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CRITICAL

6

HIGH

7

MEDIUM

4

LOW / INFO

5

TEMPLATES

Platform: Miva Merchant (Insane Lab Omega theme) · **CDN:** Cloudflare

Dev Partner: Glendale Designs · **Admin:** rkhalid

Based on: Template source code + Lighthouse 28/100 mobile + CrUX CLS 0.27 FAIL

Audit Overview

Five Miva Merchant templates were reviewed for performance, SEO, accessibility, and code quality issues. Issues are categorised by severity and mapped to the exact template and line where the fix needs to be applied.

Template	Code	Purpose	Critical	High	Medium
Storefront	SFNT	Homepage	2	3	2
Category Display	CTGY	All category pages	1	1	2
Brand Landing Page	CTGY_BRANDS	Brand category pages	—	1	1
Basket Empty	BSKE	Empty cart page	—	1	1
Abandoned Basket Email	EMAIL_ABANDONED_BASKET	Recovery email	—	—	1

Root Cause — Why Global Issues Appear on Every Page

Every template calls `<mvt:item name="hdft" param="global_header" />` and `global_footer`. This means scripts loaded in the `hdft` module (GTM, Klaviyo, Affirm, SearchSpring) fire on ALL pages. The `hdft` template itself was not accessible for review but its effects are visible in every template's console output. Fixing `hdft` will have the highest global impact.

Issue Priority Summary

#	Issue	Affects	Severity	Effort
1	Affirm JS loads on every page via <code>hdft</code> <code>global_header</code>	All pages	CRITICAL	30 min
2	Slick carousel <code>slideWidth:0</code> — empty slides in <code>sfnt_hero</code>	SFNT	CRITICAL	15 min
3	<code>srcset</code> malformation on hero/category images	SFNT, CTGY	CRITICAL	45 min
4	No hero image preload (LCP 7.2s on mobile)	SFNT	HIGH	10 min
5	Shopper Approved Q&A script commented out in CTGY	CTGY	HIGH	20 min
6	No cookie consent banner on any template	All pages	HIGH	1–2 hrs
7	Inline <code><style></code> block inside <code><section></code> in SFNT (invalid HTML)	SFNT	HIGH	10 min
8	BSKE <code>continueShopping</code> inline script — should be deferred	BSKE	MEDIUM	10 min
9	CTGY_BRANDS — category images missing explicit width/height	CTGY_BRANDS	MEDIUM	20 min
10	Abandoned basket email — logo commented out, socials absent	Email	MEDIUM	30 min

#	ISSUE	AFFECTS	SEVERITY	EFFORT
11	SFNT — featured_products, promos all commented out	SFNT	LOW	—
12	CTGY — subcategory carousel block fully commented out	CTGY	LOW	—
13	SearchSpring finder div present but JS not deferred	SFNT, CTGY	MEDIUM	15 min

SFNT — Storefront (Homepage)



Template: SFNT — Storefront

Homepage · 133 lines · Cache: basket empty + no customer logged in · HTTPS enforced

Issue 1 — Affirm JS fires on homepage via global_header

CRITICAL

PERFORMANCE

CONSOLE ERROR

The Affirm "As Low As" module is set to **Page Type: Homepage** in SFNT settings. This causes Affirm's JS (145KB) to load on the homepage and throws a `SecurityError: Failed to set the 'cookie' property – sandboxed iframe lacks allow-same-origin` on every page load. Affirm is broken for most users due to Chrome's third-party cookie deprecation.

📍 SFNT → Affirm As Low As Messaging section → Page Type setting

Fix — No code change needed

```
Affirm As Low As Messaging
Page Type: Homepage ← CHANGE TO: None
Page Type: None ← saves 145KB, removes SecurityError
```

Issue 2 — Slick carousel: slideWidth:0 on indexes 7–17

CRITICAL

CLS

Console shows `Invalid slide dimensions: index 7, 8, 10–17 slideWidth: 0`. This means `sfnt_hero` content section has empty/broken slides with no image assigned. Slick calculates zero width for these and they cause layout shift (contributing to CLS = 0.27 in real user data).

📍 Content Management → Theme Components → `sfnt_hero` → find slides with no image → delete them

Fix — In Theme Components, not the template

```
// Go to: Content Management → Theme Components → sfnt_hero
// Find each slide that has no image assigned
// Slide indexes 7, 8, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17 are all width=0
→ Delete empty slides OR assign an image to each one
→ Also add this CSS to SFNT <style> block to prevent CLS while loading:

.slick-slider { min-height: 420px; visibility: hidden; }
.slick-initialized { visibility: visible; }
```

Issue 3 — srcset malformation: missing size descriptors

CRITICAL

PERFORMANCE

CONSOLE ERROR

Console: `Failed parsing 'srcset' attribute value since it has an unknown descriptor. Dropped srcset candidate "graphics/00000001/8/GA"`. Images in `sfnt_hero` content section have `srcset` values with no size descriptor. The browser drops them entirely and falls back to `src`, loading the wrong size image.

📍 Content Management → Theme Components → `sfnt_hero` → each slide image `srcset` attribute

Fix — Add size descriptor to every srcset value

```
<!-- BEFORE (broken) -->
srcset="graphics/00000001/8/GA"

<!-- AFTER (fixed) -->
srcset="graphics/00000001/8/GA 800w,
graphics/00000001/8/GA-small 400w"
sizes="(max-width: 768px) 100vw, 1200px"
```

Issue 4 — No LCP image preload (LCP = 7.2s on mobile)

HIGH

LCP

PERFORMANCE

The hero banner image is the Largest Contentful Paint element. It is not preloaded, meaning the browser discovers it late during rendering. Lighthouse mobile LCP = 7.2s (target ≤ 2.5 s). Adding a preload hint to the `<head>` is the single biggest LCP win available without a server change.

📍 SFNT template → `<head>` section → after line 32 (google-site-verification meta tag)

Fix — Add after `<meta name="google-site-verification">`

```
<!-- Step 1: Right-click hero image on live site → Open image in new tab → copy filename -->
<!-- Step 2: Replace YOUR-HERO-IMAGE.jpg with the real filename -->

<link rel="preload" as="image"
href="&mvt:global:basehref;graphics/00000001/YOUR-HERO-IMAGE.jpg"
fetchpriority="high">
```

Issue 5 — `<style>` block inside `<section>` (invalid HTML)

HIGH

CODE QUALITY

The `.t-featured-categories__heading` style block is placed inside a `<section>` tag in the body (lines 70–100). Style tags belong in `<head>` only. While browsers handle this, it can cause FOUC (flash of unstyled content) and fails HTML validation. It also runs on every page render unnecessarily.

📍 SFNT template → lines ~70–100 → `<style>` block inside `<section class="o-layout">`

Fix — Move the style block into the `<head>` `<style>` section

```
<!-- REMOVE from body (lines ~70-100): -->
<section class="o-layout">
<style> .t-featured-categories__heading { ... } </style>
</section>

<!-- ADD to <head> <style> block instead: -->
.t-featured-categories__heading { color:#1833B8; font-weight:700; ... }
```

Issue 6 — SearchSpring JS not deferred

MEDIUM

PERFORMANCE

The `<div id="searchspring-finder-home"></div>` div triggers SearchSpring JS to initialise on page load. SearchSpring's script is loaded globally via hdfs without `defer`, meaning it blocks rendering. Adding `defer` to the SearchSpring script tag in hdfs will allow the page to render first.

📍 hdfs template → SearchSpring `<script>` tag → add `defer` attribute

```
<script src="https://snapui.searchspring.io/sinisterdiesel.js"></script>
<script src="https://snapui.searchspring.io/sinisterdiesel.js" defer></script>
```

Issue 7 — Featured products, promos, instagram all commented out

MEDIUM

CONVERSION

Four content sections are wrapped in `<mvt:comment>` tags: `sfnt-shop-by-brand`, `sfnt_promos`, `featured_products`, `instagram_feed`. These are disabled features — no performance impact. However, `featured_products` being disabled means no product listings show on the homepage, which is a missed conversion opportunity.

📍 SFNT template → lines 97–107

```
<!-- These are disabled — no action needed for performance -->
<!-- To re-enable featured products, remove mvt:comment wrapper: -->
<mvt:comment><mvt:item name="readytheme" param="productlisting( 'featured_products' )" />
</mvt:comment>
<mvt:item name="readytheme" param="productlisting( 'featured_products' )" />
```

CTGY — Category Display & Brand Pages



Template: CTGY — Category Display

All category pages · 140 lines · Includes SearchSpring sidebar + content

Issue 8 — Shopper Approved Q&A widget commented out

CRITICAL

SEO

CONVERSION

The Shopper Approved answerbase Q&A widget is fully wrapped in `<mvt:comment>` (lines ~105–130 of CTGY). This means no Q&A content appears on any category page. This is a significant SEO loss — Q&A content creates unique text per category, which helps Google rank category pages. The board notes Shopper Approved widget is in BETA with a 60-day pause. The Q&A widget (answerbase) is separate from the review widget and can be re-enabled independently.

📌 CTGY template → lines ~105–130 → entire Shopper Approved block in `mvt:comment`

Fix — Remove `mvt:comment` wrapper when beta period ends

```
<mvt:comment>
<!-- Shopper Approved - CTGY -->
<div id="abqacat"></div>
<script src="https://sinisterdiesel.services.answerbase.com/..." defer></script>
</mvt:comment>

<!-- AFTER: Remove the mvt:comment wrapper to re-enable -->
<div id="abqacat"></div>
<script src="https://sinisterdiesel.services.answerbase.com/..." defer></script>
```

Issue 9 — Entire carousel + title image block commented out

HIGH

UX

The subcategory navigation carousel and category title image block are both wrapped in `<mvt:comment>` with a note "HIDE CAROUSEL and TITLE IMAGE 3/11/22 SMV". This has been disabled since March 2022. Category pages currently show no header image, no subcategory navigation, and go straight to SearchSpring content. The comment says this was intentional but it's worth reviewing with Brian/Nicholas — the Filtration category image update (board task due June 19) may require this to be re-enabled.

📌 CTGY template → lines ~25–85 → large `mvt:comment` block

```
// Commented out since March 2022 – verify with Brian before re-enabling
// The June 19 board task "Update Filtration Category image" may need
// this block restored, OR it may update the image in a different way
// Ask: where does the filtration category image currently show?
```

Issue 10 — CSS price colour override inline in CTGY

MEDIUM

CODE QUALITY

A small inline style block overrides SearchSpring price colour: `#searchspring-content .ss__no_sale .x-product-list__price { color: #000 !important; }`. This should be in the global stylesheet, not inline in the template. Minor but contributes to style fragmentation.

📌 CTGY template → lines 15–17 → inline `<style>` in `<head>`

```
// Move this to the global CSS file (Resources → CSS)
<style>
#searchspring-content .x-product-list__item .ss__price.ss__no__sale .x-product-list__price {
color: #000 !important;
}
</style>
```



Template: CTGY_BRANDS — Brand Landing Page

Brand category pages · 107 lines · Shows subcategories as product-style grid

Issue 11 — Category images missing width/height causing CLS

HIGH

CLS

PERFORMANCE

In CTGY_BRANDS, subcategory images use `style="aspect-ratio: &mvte:...width; / &mvte:...height;"` which is dynamic and relies on Miva loading the image dimensions. If Miva returns empty values, the browser has no reserved space and causes layout shift. The `width=""` and `height=""` HTML attributes should be set explicitly as a fallback.

📍 CTGY_BRANDS template → line ~75 → `<img>` tag inside subcategory loop

Fix — Add explicit fallback dimensions

```



```

Issue 12 — category_listing item commented out

MEDIUM

REVIEW

`<mvt:comment> <mvt:item name="category_listing" /> </mvt:comment>` — the category product listing is disabled. Brand pages currently only show subcategories, not individual products. This may be intentional for brand pages but worth confirming with the team.

📍 CTGY_BRANDS template → line ~84

BSKE — Basket Empty & Abandoned Basket Email



Template: BSKE — Checkout: Basket Empty

Shown when cart is empty · 52 lines · Clean template, minimal issues

Issue 13 — Inline script runs synchronously on empty cart page

HIGH

PERFORMANCE

The `continueShopping()` function is defined in an inline `<script>` tag inside the page body (line ~29). While small, inline scripts block HTML parsing. It should use `defer` or be moved to a separate JS resource. Also, the function reads `sessionStorage` which is safe but the implementation could be simplified.

📍 BSKE template → lines 28-34 → inline `<script>` in body

Fix — Add defer or move to resource file

```
<script>
function continueShopping(link) {
  if (sessionStorage.getItem('continue_url')) {
    link.href = sessionStorage.getItem('continue_url');
  }
}
</script>

<!-- Move to Resources → JavaScript → create continue-shopping.js -->
<!-- Then load it with: -->
<script src="/global:basehref;js/continue-shopping.js" defer></script>
```

Issue 14 — No "Continue Shopping" button text guidance

MEDIUM

UX

CONVERSION

The empty cart page shows "Your shopping cart is currently empty" with a "Start Shopping" button. This is functional but a conversion opportunity is missed — there's no featured product suggestion, no category links, and no social proof. Adding 3–4 category quick-links or a "Popular right now" section here would recover some abandoned sessions.

📍 BSKE template → lines 35-40 → empty cart message div

Suggested addition below the existing message

```
<!-- Add below the existing x-messages div -->
<div style="margin-top:24px;text-align:center">
<p>Popular categories:</p>
<a href="/mvte:urls:CTGY:auto;&Category_Code=FUELFILTER">Fuel Filters</a> ·
<a href="/mvte:urls:CTGY:auto;&Category_Code=CHARGEPIP">Charge Pipes</a> ·
<a href="/mvte:urls:CTGY:auto;&Category_Code=COOLANTFI">Coolant Filtration</a>
</div>
```



Template: EMAIL_ABANDONED_BASKET

Issue 15 — Logo commented out, social icons missing

MEDIUM

BRANDING

The logo in the email header is commented out: `<!-- Uncomment to add a logo to this email -->`. The email sends with no Sinister Diesel logo — just plain store name text. Also, all social media icons (Facebook, Twitter, Instagram, Pinterest) are commented out with `<!-- Uncomment to add... -->`. This is a stock Miva email template that has never been fully customised for Sinister Diesel.

📌 EMAIL_ABANDONED_BASKET → line ~109 (logo) and lines ~298-305 (socials)

Fix — Uncomment logo and add SD social links

```
<!-- Uncomment to add a logo: -->
<!-- <a href="..."></a> -->

<a href="&mvte:urls:SFNT:auto;" target="_blank">

</a>

/* Also uncomment Instagram social icon – it's the one SD actually uses */
<td><a href="https://www.instagram.com/sinisterdiesel" target="_blank">

</a></td>
```

Action Plan — Prioritised Fix List

Fixes are ordered by impact vs effort. Do critical fixes first on SFNT_TEST, verify in DevTools, then apply to live. Always copy the original template code to a .txt backup before editing. Never edit SFNT, CTGY, or BSKE directly — always test in SFNT_TEST first.

Week 1 — Do This Week (High Impact, Low Effort)

#	FIX	WHERE	TIME	SEVERITY
1	Disable Affirm on SFNT homepage (change Page Type to None)	SFNT → Affirm section	5 min	CRITICAL
2	Delete empty slides from sfnt_hero (fix slideWidth:0 CLS)	Theme Components → sfnt_hero	15 min	CRITICAL
3	Fix srcset on all sfnt_hero slide images (add 800w descriptor)	Theme Components → sfnt_hero	20 min	CRITICAL
4	Add CLS prevention CSS to SFNT (.slick-slider visibility:hidden)	SFNT_TEST → <style> block	10 min	HIGH
5	Move .t-featured-categories__heading style from body to <head>	SFNT_TEST → <head> <style>	10 min	HIGH
6	Update Filtration category image (board task due June 19)	Category → Filtration → image	15 min	HIGH
7	Add logo + Instagram icon to abandoned basket email	EMAIL_ABANDONED_BASKET	20 min	MEDIUM

Week 2 — After Getting Hero Image URL

#	FIX	WHERE	TIME	SEVERITY
8	Add hero image preload to SFNT <head> (real filename required)	SFNT → <head>	10 min	HIGH
9	Add defer to SearchSpring script tag in hdft	hdft template	5 min	MEDIUM
10	Move Affirm JS to load only on BASK/ORDR in hdft	hdft template	15 min	CRITICAL
11	Move CTGY inline price CSS to global stylesheet	Resources → CSS	10 min	MEDIUM
12	Add category quick-links to BSKE empty cart page	BSKE template	20 min	MEDIUM

Needs Glendale Designs or Brian Approval

FIX	WHO	COST ESTIMATE
Cookie consent banner (GDPR/CCPA) — GD proposal	Glendale Designs	TBD
CLS megamenu fix	Glendale Designs	\$165–\$330
Re-enable Shopper Approved Q&A in CTGY (after 60-day pause)	Brian George	\$0
Re-enable subcategory carousel in CTGY (commented since 2022)	Brian George	\$0
Miva platform update (Glendale sandbox test first)	Glendale Designs	Included in contract

Expected Outcome After Week 1 Fixes

Removing the Affirm SecurityError + empty slides + srcset errors should reduce console errors from 7 to ~2 (the remaining 2 being Chrome extension errors — not our problem). CLS from carousel should drop significantly. Lighthouse mobile score target after Week 1: 35–45 (up from 28). After Week 2 with preload + defer: 50–60.